

# Nonlinear Dynamics & Chaos HW3

Daniel Haim Breger, 316136944

*Technion*

(Date: July 4, 2026)

# 1 Coexistence in the two-species competition model

## 1.1 fixed points

at the fixed point

$$x(1 - x - ay) = 0 \qquad y(1 - y - ax) = 0 \quad (1)$$

which gives the fixed points, by guessing smartly

$$(0, 0) \quad (1, 0) \quad (0, 1) \quad (2)$$

but all three of those represent extinction of one or both species. We're interested in coexistence, i.e when  $x, y \neq 0$  so

$$x + ay = 1 \qquad ax + y = 1 \quad (3)$$

subtracting the two equations gives  $x = y$  so the fixed point is

$$(x, y) = \left( \frac{1}{1+a}, \frac{1}{1+a} \right) \quad (4)$$

## 1.2 condition on a

The jacobina is

$$J = \begin{pmatrix} 1 - 2x - ay & -ax \\ -ay & 1 - 2y - ax \end{pmatrix} \quad (5)$$

and at each fixed point

$$J(0, 0) = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \quad (6)$$

$$J(0, 1) = \begin{pmatrix} 1 - a & 0 \\ -a & -1 \end{pmatrix} \quad (7)$$

$$J(1, 0) = \begin{pmatrix} -1 & -a \\ 0 & 1 - a \end{pmatrix} \quad (8)$$

The eigenvalues for 0, 0 are both 1 so it is an unstable node for all  $a > 0$ . for the other points, the eigenvalues are  $-1$  and  $1 - a$ , so they are stable nodes for  $0 < a < 1$  and a saddle for  $a > 1$ . For the coexistence fixed point the jacobian is

$$J = \begin{pmatrix} 1 - \frac{2}{1+a} - \frac{a}{1+a} & -\frac{a}{1+a} \\ -\frac{a}{1+a} & 1 - \frac{2}{1+a} - \frac{a}{1+a} \end{pmatrix} = \frac{-1}{1+a} \begin{pmatrix} 1 & a \\ a & 1 \end{pmatrix} \quad (9)$$

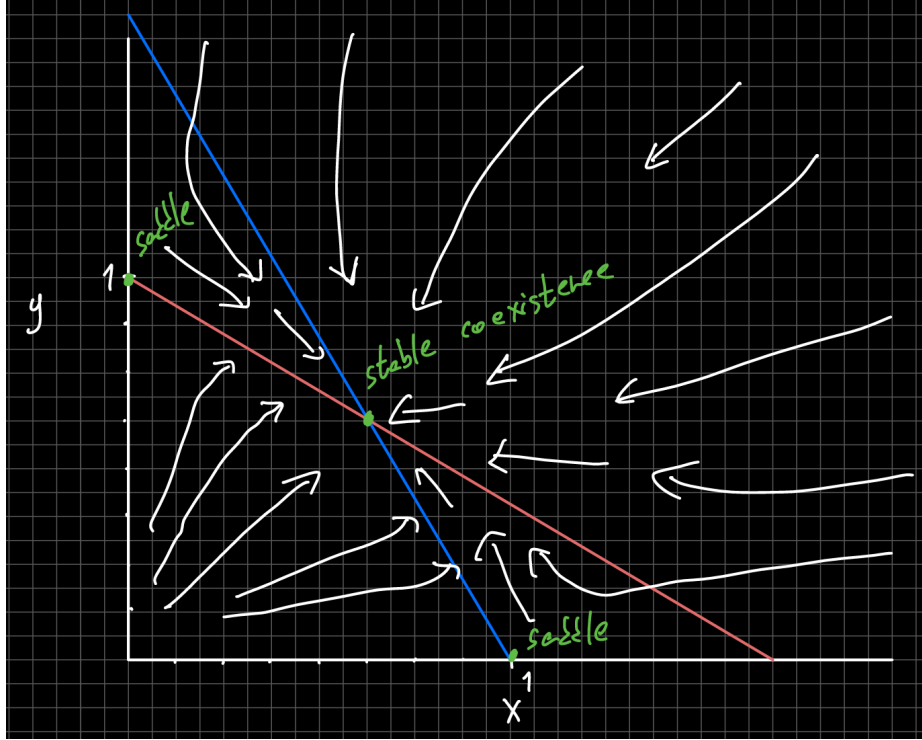
we can easily see the eigenvectors are  $(1, 1)$  and  $(1, -1)$  so the eigenvalues are

$$\lambda_1 = \frac{-1}{1+a} (1+a) = -1 \quad (10)$$

$$\lambda_2 = \frac{-1}{1+a} (1-a) = \frac{a-1}{a+1} \quad (11)$$

so the coexistence is a stable node for  $0 < a < 1$  and a saddle for  $a > 1$ .

### 1.3 phase space portrait



The x-nullclines are

$$x = 0, \quad 1 - x - ay = 0 \implies y = \frac{1-x}{a} \quad (12)$$

and the y-nullclines

$$y = 0, \quad 1 - y - ax = 0 \implies y = 1 - ax \quad (13)$$

their intersection point is

$$\left( \frac{1}{1+a}, \frac{1}{1+a} \right) \quad (14)$$

looking at the other fixed points,  $(0,0)$  is a source, and both  $(0,1)$  and  $(1,0)$  are saddles, meaning that if we start at  $x > 0, y > 0$  we eventually must end up at  $\left( \frac{1}{1+a}, \frac{1}{1+a} \right)$ .

## 2 A simple model of an epidemic

### 2.1 fixed points

for the fixed points

$$xky = 0 \qquad y(kx - l) = 0 \qquad (15)$$

so all  $(x, 0)$  is a line of fixed points, representing the case where there is no epidemic anymore.

### 2.2 trajectories

$$\frac{dy}{dx} = \frac{\dot{y}}{\dot{x}} = \frac{kxy - ly}{-kxy} = -1 + \frac{l}{kx} \qquad (16)$$

integrating

$$y = -x + \frac{l}{k} \ln x + C \qquad (17)$$

so the conserved quantity is

$$H = x + y - \frac{l}{k} \ln x \qquad (18)$$

so we can say

$$x + y - \frac{l}{k} \ln x = x_0 + y_0 - \frac{l}{k} \ln x_0 \qquad (19)$$

therefore

$$y = y_0 + x_0 - x + \frac{l}{k} \ln \left( \frac{x}{x_0} \right) \qquad (20)$$

### 2.3 sketch

#### 2.3.1 nullclines

the nullclines for the  $\dot{x}$  expression are

$$x = 0, \quad y = 0 \qquad (21)$$

and for  $\dot{y}$

$$x = \frac{l}{k}, \quad y = 0 \qquad (22)$$

and for every point  $x, y > 0$  we have  $\dot{x} = -kxy < 0$ , so all the trajectories move left, and it's pretty simple to see that  $\dot{y} > 0$  when  $x > l/k$  and vice versa. So the trajectories point left and up to the right of  $x = l/k$  and down to the left of it.

#### 2.3.2 maximized y

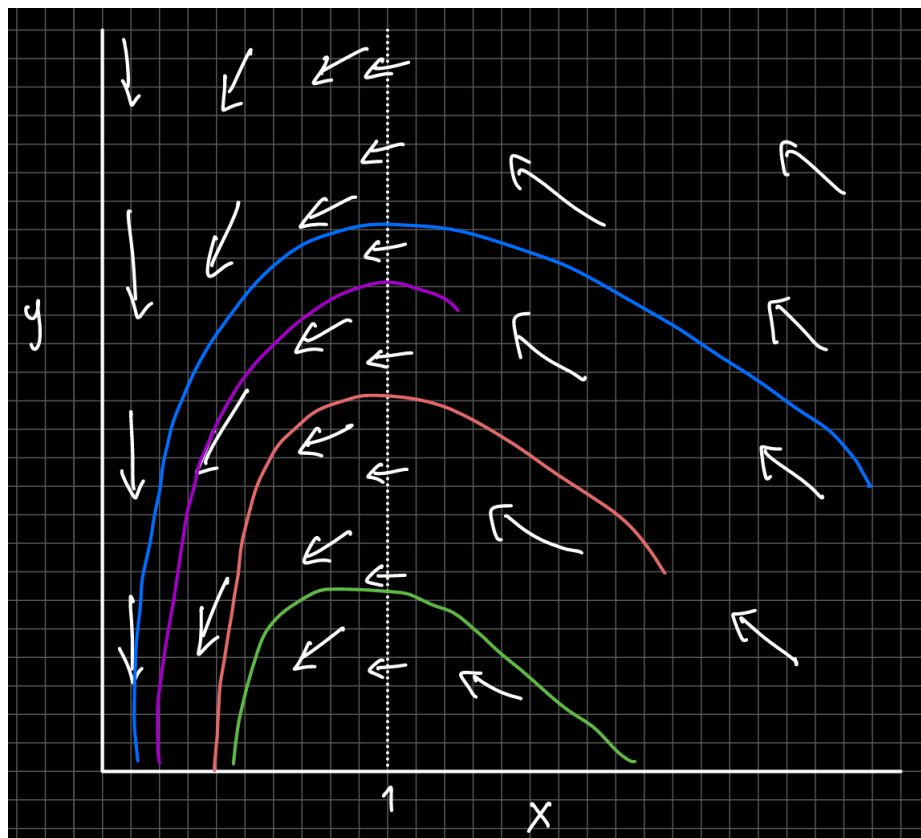
a maxima happens when  $\dot{y} = 0$  so in our case

$$x = l/k \qquad (23)$$

inserting into our expression for  $y$ , when  $x_0 > l/k$

$$y_{max} = y_0 + x_0 - \frac{l}{k} + \frac{l}{k} \ln \left( \frac{l/k}{x_0} \right) \qquad (24)$$

and when  $x_0 < l/k$   $y$  immediately decreases making  $y_0$  the maximum.



## 2.4 Epidemic threshold

at  $t = 0$

$$\dot{y}(0) = y_0 (kx_0 - l) \quad (25)$$

and since  $y_0 > 0$

$$\dot{y}(0) > 0 \implies kx_0 - l > 0 \implies x_0 > \frac{l}{k} \quad (26)$$

using  $R_0 = kx_0/l$  then the condition is

$$R_0 > 1 \quad (27)$$

lowering the susceptible pool can prevent an outbreak by lowering the ratio  $l/k$ , thus lowering  $R_0$  below 1 further.

### 3 Phase portrait of the conservative pendulum

I'll define a helper variable

$$v = \dot{\theta} \quad (28)$$

so the equation becomes

$$\dot{v} = -\sin \theta \quad (29)$$

#### 3.1 fixed points

at the fixed points

$$v = 0, \quad \sin \theta = 0 \quad (30)$$

so

$$(\theta^*, v^*) = (\pi n, 0) \quad (31)$$

next the jacobian is

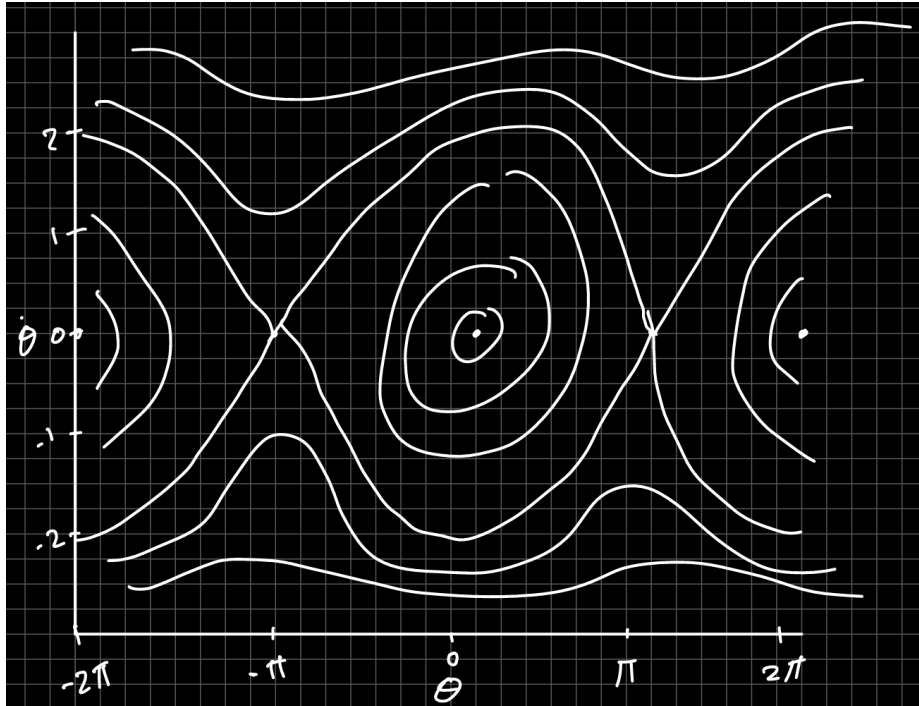
$$J = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ -\cos \theta & 0 \end{pmatrix} \quad (32)$$

we can split the fixed points into two groups, for even and odd  $n$ . Even  $n$  gives  $\cos(\dots) = 1$  therefore the eigenvalues are  $\pm i$ , so these are linear centers. Odd  $n$  gives  $\cos(\dots) = -1$  so the eigenvalues are  $\pm 1$ , and since both eigenvalues are real but one is positive and the other is negative these are saddles.

#### 3.2 genuine centers

Conservation of energy guarantees this. This can be shown explicitly by calculating the energy, but even a verbal argument I believe shows this. If we assume a trajectory which either spirals into or away from one such fixed point, it means the pendulum must be simultaneously moving away/toward from the fixed point physically and also gathering/losing velocity as it does so. This means energy is introduced/taken away from the system. Since this is impossible as we assume an isolated system, trajectories must be closed curves surrounding the fixed points, meaning they are genuine centers.

### 3.3 phase plane



The energy of the system is

$$E = \frac{1}{2}v^2 + 1 - \cos \theta \quad (33)$$

and the energy at the saddle points is

$$E((2m+1)\pi, 0) = 1 - \cos((2m+1)\pi) = 2 \quad (34)$$

so the separatrix is

$$\frac{1}{2}v^2 + 1 - \cos \theta = 2 \quad (35)$$

solving for v

$$v = \pm \sqrt{2(1 + \cos \theta)} \quad (36)$$

which can be written as

$$v = \pm 2 \cos \left( \frac{\theta}{2} \right) \quad (37)$$

which represents a pendulum with just enough energy to reach the top of its motion with 0 velocity.

## 4 Period of a relaxation oscillation

### 4.1 Lienard variable

the lienard variable

$$y = \frac{\dot{x}}{k} + F(x) \quad (38)$$

so

$$\dot{x} = k(y - F(x)) \quad (39)$$

and

$$\dot{y} = \frac{\ddot{x}}{k} + F'(x)\dot{x} = \frac{\ddot{x} + k(x^2 - 4)\dot{x}}{k} \quad (40)$$

inserting the original equation

$$\dot{y} = \frac{1 - x}{k} \quad (41)$$

so the system is

$$\dot{x} = k\left(y - \frac{x^3}{3} + 4x\right) \quad \dot{y} = \frac{1 - x}{k} \quad (42)$$

and we can notice that  $x$  is fast and  $y$  is slow.

### 4.2 slow parts

The stability if the fast part is determined by

$$\frac{\partial \dot{x}}{\partial x} = -kF'(x) = -k(x^2 - 4) \quad (43)$$

which is attracting when

$$F'(x) = x^2 - 4 > 0 \quad (44)$$

i.e

$$x < -2 \quad \text{or} \quad x > 2 \quad (45)$$

so we look at  $x = \pm 2$  with

$$F(2) = -\frac{16}{3} \quad F(-2) = \frac{16}{3} \quad (46)$$

finding the other points at which we get these values

$$x^3 - 12x - 16 = 0 \implies (x - 4)(x + 2)^2 \quad (47)$$

so the trajectory jumps

$$(-2, 16/3) \rightarrow (4, 16/3) \quad (48)$$

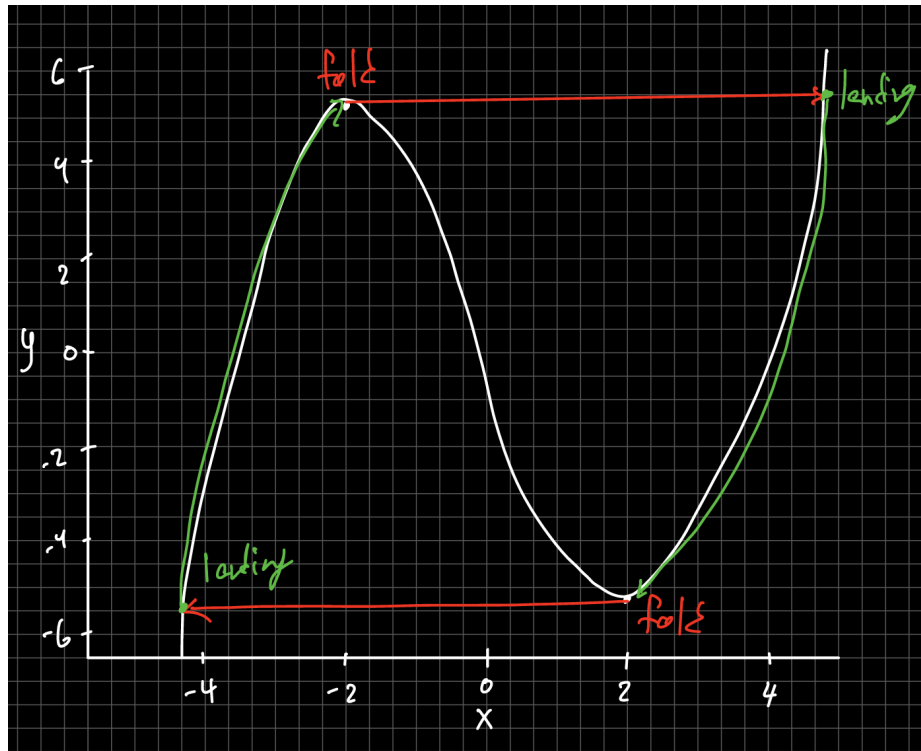
similarly

$$(2, -16/3) \rightarrow (-4, -16/3) \quad (49)$$

so the slow parts are

$$(-4, -16/3) \rightarrow (-2, 16/3) \quad (4, 16/3) \rightarrow (2, -16/3) \quad (50)$$





### 4.3 period

on a slow branch

$$y \sim F(x) \quad (51)$$

so

$$\dot{y} \sim F'(x)\dot{x} = (x^2 - 4)\dot{x} \quad (52)$$

using  $\dot{y} = \frac{1-x}{k}$

$$\dot{x} = \frac{1-x}{k(x^2-4)} \quad (53)$$

so

$$dt = k \frac{x^2-4}{1-x} dx \quad (54)$$

so

$$T = k \int_a^b \frac{x^2-4}{1-x} dx = k \left( -\frac{x^2}{2} - x + 3 \ln |x-1| \right) \Big|_a^b \quad (55)$$

on the right branch x goes from 4 to 2 so

$$T_R = k \left( -\frac{x^2}{2} - x + 3 \ln |x-1| \right) \Big|_4^2 = k(8 - 3 \ln 3) \quad (56)$$

and on the left x goes from -4 to -2

$$T_L = k \left( -\frac{x^2}{2} - x + 3 \ln |x-1| \right) \Big|_{-4}^{-2} = k \left( 4 - 3 \ln \frac{5}{3} \right) \quad (57)$$

so the period time is approximately

$$T = T_R + T_L = k(8 - 3 \ln 3) + k \left( 4 - 3 \ln \frac{5}{3} \right) = k(12 - 3 \ln 5) \quad (58)$$

## 5 Secular terms in weakly non-linear oscillators

the equation is

$$\ddot{x} + x = -\varepsilon (a_2 x^2 + a_3 x^3), \quad 0 < \varepsilon \ll 1 \quad (59)$$

### 5.1 two time expansion

we define

$$\tau = t \quad T = \varepsilon t \quad (60)$$

so that

$$\partial_t = \partial_\tau + \varepsilon \partial_T \quad (61)$$

and

$$\partial_t^2 = \partial_\tau^2 + 2\varepsilon \partial_\tau \partial_T + O(\varepsilon^2) \quad (62)$$

we expand

$$x = x_0(\tau, T) + \varepsilon x_1(\tau, T) + O(\varepsilon^2) \quad (63)$$

substituting into the equation

$$(\partial_\tau^2 + 2\varepsilon \partial_\tau \partial_T)(x_0 + \varepsilon x_1) + x_0 + \varepsilon x_1 = -\varepsilon (a_2 x_0^2 + a_3 x_0^3) + O(\varepsilon^2) \quad (64)$$

and at  $O(1)$

$$\partial_\tau^2 x_0 + x_0 = 0 \quad (65)$$

whose solution can be written as

$$x_0(\tau, T) = r(T) \cos \psi, \quad \psi = \tau + \phi(T) \quad (66)$$

where  $r$  is the amplitude and  $\phi$  is the phase. At order  $O(\varepsilon)$

$$\partial_\tau^2 x_1 + x_1 = -2\partial_\tau \partial_T x_0 - a_2 x_0^2 - a_3 x_0^3 \quad (67)$$

### 5.2 higher harmonics

Starting from

$$x_0 = r \cos \psi \quad (68)$$

then

$$\partial_T x_0 = \partial_T r \cos \psi - r \partial_T \phi \sin \psi \quad (69)$$

then

$$\partial_\tau \partial_T x_0 = -\partial_T r \sin \psi - r \partial_T \phi \cos \psi \quad (70)$$

so

$$-2\partial_\tau \partial_T x_0 = \partial_T r \sin \psi + r \partial_T \phi \cos \psi \quad (71)$$

and using the identities

$$\cos^2 \psi = \frac{1}{2} (1 + \cos 2\psi) \quad \cos^3 \psi = \frac{1}{4} (3 \cos \psi + \cos 3\psi) \quad (72)$$

we get

$$-a_2 x_0^2 = -\frac{a_2 r^2}{2} - \frac{a_2 r^2}{2} \cos 2\psi \quad (73)$$

and

$$-a_3 x_0^3 = -\frac{3a_3 r^3}{4} \cos \psi - \frac{a_3 r^3}{4} \cos 3\psi \quad (74)$$

combining everything

$$\partial_\tau^2 x_1 + x_1 = \partial_T r \sin \psi + \left( 2r \partial_T \phi - \frac{3a_3 r^3}{4} \right) \cos \psi - \frac{a_2 r^2}{2} (1 + \cos 2\psi) - \frac{a_3 r^3}{4} \cos 3\psi \quad (75)$$

### 5.3 resonant terms

The resonant terms are  $2\partial_T r \sin \psi$  and  $\left( 2r \partial_T \phi - \frac{3a_3 r^3}{4} \right) \cos \psi$ . To eliminate secular growth their coefficients must vanish so

$$\partial_T r = 0 \implies r(T) = r_0 \quad (76)$$

and

$$\partial_T \phi = \frac{3a_3 r^2}{8} \implies \phi(T) = \phi_0 + \frac{3}{8} a_3 r_0^2 T \quad (77)$$

inserting  $T = \varepsilon t$

$$x(t) \simeq r_0 \cos \left( \left( 1 + \frac{3}{8} \varepsilon a_3 r_0^2 \right) t + \phi_0 \right) \quad (78)$$

### 5.4 duffing oscillator

in the duffing oscillator

$$a_2 = 0, \quad a_3 = 1 \quad (79)$$

giving

$$\partial_T r = 0, \quad \partial_T \phi = \frac{3}{8} r^2 \quad (80)$$

A nonzero quadratic nonlinearity  $a_2$  doesn't change the leading order slow equations because

$$x_0^2 = \frac{r^2}{2} (1 + \cos 2\psi) \quad (81)$$

only has a constant term and a second harmonic, and since it doesn't have the natural frequency of the oscillator, it's not resonant.

### 5.5 averaged equations

The averaged equations from the notes are

$$\dot{A} = \varepsilon \langle h \sin \theta \rangle, \quad A \dot{\phi} = \varepsilon \langle h \cos \theta \rangle, \quad \langle \cdot \rangle = \frac{1}{2\pi} \int_{-\pi}^{\pi} (\cdot) d\theta \quad (82)$$

inserting

$$x = A \cos \theta, \quad \dot{x} = -A \sin \theta \quad (83)$$

where  $\theta = t + \phi(t)$  into  $h$

$$h = A^3 \cos \theta \sin^2 \theta \quad (84)$$

making the amplitude equation

$$\dot{A} = \varepsilon A^3 \langle \cos \theta \sin^3 \theta \rangle \quad (85)$$

but the average over a period of the trig function zeroes

$$\dot{A} = 0 \quad (86)$$

and for the phase

$$A \dot{\phi} = \varepsilon A^3 \langle \cos^2 \theta \sin^2 \theta \rangle \quad (87)$$

$$= \varepsilon A^3 \left\langle \frac{1}{4} \sin^2 2\theta \right\rangle \quad (88)$$

$$= \frac{\varepsilon A^3}{4} \cdot \frac{1}{2} \quad (89)$$

$$= \frac{\varepsilon A^3}{8} \quad (90)$$

therefore

$$\dot{\phi} = \frac{\varepsilon A^2}{8} \quad (91)$$

## 5.6 solution

For the amplitude,

$$A = A_0 \quad (92)$$

to be determined by the initial condition. For the phase,

$$\phi = \phi_0 + \frac{\varepsilon A^2}{8} t \quad (93)$$

so the averaged solution is

$$x(t) \simeq A_0 \cos \left( \left( 1 + \frac{\varepsilon A^2}{8} \right) t + \phi_0 \right) \quad (94)$$

in leading order, and the initial conditions have

$$x(0) = A_0 \cos \phi_0, \quad \dot{x}(0) = -A_0 \sin \phi_0 \quad (95)$$

which we can combine and rearrange to

$$A_0 \simeq \sqrt{x(0)^2 + \dot{x}(0)^2} \quad (96)$$

So the slow flow predicts that the amplitude remains constant at its initial value. There is no attracting value of  $A$  meaning the system also doesn't have a limit cycle. Looking at the frequency

$$\omega = 1 + \frac{\varepsilon A_0^2}{8} \tag{97}$$

we see it only depends on the initial amplitude, so once that is set, the frequency is also constant.